

PriceBack — App Review Guide

iOS 2.8.2 · Prosoft Inc · Attachment to App Review Information. This is the full version of the reviewer notes; the Notes field carries an abridged copy.

Sign-in — how the reviewer gets in

iOS: no demo account needed — use Sign in with Apple

Tap "Continue with Apple" on the sign-in screen. It is the first button on iOS. The reviewer's own Apple ID creates a normal account, Hide My Email is fully supported, and the 75 free credits land immediately — the entire app is reviewable with no credentials from us.

This is deliberately the instruction we give Apple rather than a shared Google account, because a Google demo account is a trap on a review device: signing into an unfamiliar device routinely triggers Google's own verification challenge (a code sent to the account owner's phone), which the reviewer cannot clear. That failure looks like a broken sign-in and gets rejected under Guideline 2.1. Sign in with Apple has no such interstitial.

Onboarding after sign-in asks for a region — use these values

The app serves Canadian retailer price-adjustment policies only, so the setup step requires a Canadian postal code and province. Any valid pair works; these are convenient:

- **Postal code:** M5V 3L9
- **Province:** Ontario
- Country is fixed to Canada and cannot be changed.

Then tick the two required agreement checkboxes (Terms of Service, Privacy Policy — both open the live public documents) and tap Finish. The optional referral-code field can be left empty.

Android / Play: same flow, Google Sign-In

Android offers Google Sign-In only (Sign in with Apple is iOS-only). If the Play reviewer prefers not to use their own Google account, contact maxim.lucas@viacesi.fr and a dedicated test account will be provisioned within one business day.

What the app does

PriceBack helps Canadians reclaim money from retailer price-adjustment policies. Workflow:

1. User scans a paper receipt with the camera (or imports one from photos).
2. We OCR it and extract the items, prices, store, and purchase date.
3. We periodically check current retailer prices for each item until the store's published price-adjustment window closes (typically 14–100 days).
4. When the price drops, the user gets a notification with the savings amount and a one-tap "Claim" flow that opens an email / phone / in-store talking-points sheet to request the price match.

We do not handle any retailer transactions ourselves. We surface the opportunity; the user files the claim with the retailer directly.

How to test the core flows in ~3 minutes

After signing in:

1. **Receipt scan** — tap the camera FAB (center of the tab bar). Either take a photo of any receipt, or use **Choose Photo** → pick anything from the gallery. OCR runs; you land on the parsed-items review screen. Tap **Save Receipt**.

No Costco receipt to hand? Any receipt photo exercises the full path — the camera, the OCR round-trip, the parsed-item review screen, and the save. Items the parser can't recognise can be corrected or added by hand on that screen (" + Add item"), so a saved receipt and the tracking flow behind it are reachable from any photo at all.

1. **Home screen** — the saved receipt now appears under "Products you're tracking" with a coloured chip (green / yellow / red urgency tier based on adjustment-window remaining).
2. **Detail screen** — tap the receipt. You can see the items list, edit any line (name, price, qty, SKU), add a new item via "+ Add item", edit the receipt header (date, total, tax, warehouse #), and trigger a price refresh via "Refresh prices".
3. **Profile** — tap the profile tab. Try:
 - **Download my data** → produces a JSON export of everything stored.
 - **Delete my account** → permanently wipes the account (you'll be signed out — sign back in to continue testing).
 - **Export Data** → generates a PDF report of claimed price-adjustments for a month / quarter / year.
4. **Stores tab** — launches with Costco as the only active retailer (full claim flow + weekly flyer overlay + crowdsourced warehouse pricing). The 19 other Canadian retailers are visible in the list with a "Coming soon" pill and full policy data so reviewers can see the roadmap — they are not silently hidden. Each disabled row offers a per-store "Notify me when it launches" opt-in (stored locally, mirrored to the backend when signed in). Scanning a non-Costco receipt is intentionally a no-op: OCR runs so the user sees we detected the store correctly, but Save is replaced with the same launch-notification CTA and no scan credit is consumed. Stores are flipped to active by toggling `enabled: true` in `backend/data/policies.json` (STORE-02 remote-refresh — no app release required) or in `src/constants/stores.js` for the bundled fallback.

Permissions — why we ask

- **Camera (NSCameraUsageDescription / android.permission.CAMERA)** — receipt scanning is the core action; required.
- **Photo library (NSPhotoLibraryUsageDescription on iOS; on Android: no permission at all)** — alternate path: importing a pre-existing receipt photo without re-taking it. On Android this goes through

the **system photo picker** (expo-image-picker on SDK 55 uses `PickVisualMedia`), which grants per-item access without any media permission — see the stripped list below.

- **Notifications** (`NSUserNotificationsUsageDescription` / `POST_NOTIFICATIONS`) — alerting users when a watched item drops in price (the whole product premise).
- **Approximate location** (`CLLocationWhenInUse` / `ACCESS_COARSE_LOCATION`) — used only to pick the nearest Costco for in-warehouse price-tag scans. **Coarse only; we do not request precise/fine location.**
- **Background fetch** (`RECEIVE_BOOT_COMPLETED` + `WAKE_LOCK`) — expo-task-manager re-registers price-check tasks after device reboot.

We deliberately strip the advertising ID (`AD_ID`), microphone (`RECORD_AUDIO`), precise location (`ACCESS_FINE_LOCATION`) and broad media-read (`READ_MEDIA_IMAGES`, `READ_MEDIA_VIDEO`, `READ_MEDIA_AUDIO`) permissions that our SDKs pull in transitively but the app never uses — so the shipped manifest requests only the permissions listed above. No contacts, no microphone, no precise location, no health data, no advertising ID, no cross-app tracking.

The media-read trio came from `expo-media-library`, whose config plugin Expo autolinks (it is never listed in `app.json`) with a default of `granularPermissions: ['photo', 'video', 'audio']`. Version code 20 was flagged under Play's photo-and-video permissions policy for exactly this; version code 21 removes all three at two independent layers — `android.blockedPermissions` in `app.json` (keeps them out of the requested permission set entirely) and `plugins/withAndroidPermissionCleanup.js` (neutralises any dependency manifest that declares them at merge time). Nothing in the app used them: all image picking goes through the system photo picker, and `READ_MEDIA_VISUAL_USER_SELECTED` (the partial-access permission Play sanctions) is kept.

Sign in with Apple (iOS only)

Enabled per App Store guideline 4.8 and offered as the **first** button on the sign-in screen. Hide My Email relay addresses are accepted end to end: the backend verifies Apple's RS256 identity token against Apple's JWKS and keys the account on the `sub` claim, so an account created with a relay address works identically to one with a real address. Nothing in the app requires the real address.

Independence from the retailers we support

PriceBack is an independent app with no relationship to any retailer. Retailer names appear only to identify whose published price-adjustment policy applies to a given receipt, and the in-app store list links to each retailer's own public policy page. We use no retailer logos, wordmarks, or trade dress, the app name and icon reference no retailer, and no retailer's name is used in our App Store keywords. We take no part in any retailer transaction — the user files their claim with the retailer directly.

Account-gated internal tools (nothing hidden)

Four maintainer screens exist in the binary — price-tag review, weekly-flyer ingestion, credit reconciliation, and a barcode→SKU feeder. They are not hidden features: their Profile entries render only when the **server** reports the signed-in account is on the maintainer allow-list, and every backing endpoint independently

rejects non-allow-listed accounts. A reviewer account will not see them and cannot reach them. They are internal data-curation tooling, contain no user-facing functionality, and gate nothing the user has paid for.

Privacy + data rights

- Privacy policy: <https://priceback.ca/privacy-policy> (English)
- Politique de confidentialité : <https://priceback.ca/privacy-fr> (Français — for Quebec residents per Law 25 §43)
- Terms of Service: <https://priceback.ca/terms-of-service>
- Support: <https://priceback.ca/support>

We comply with PIPEDA (federal), Quebec Law 25, Alberta PIPA, British Columbia PIPA, CCPA, and GDPR. Privacy officer is named in the policy and reachable at privacy@priceback.ca.

The app provides in-app **Download my data** (GDPR Art 20 portability) and **Delete my account** (GDPR Art 17 erasure / Law 25 §28) under Profile.

Third-party services we use

Service	Purpose	Country
Google Cloud Vision	Receipt OCR	US
Google AI Studio (Gemini)	OCR reconciliation when the heuristic parser is inconsistent (opt-in)	US
Sentry	Crash reporting (no PII; payloads scrubbed before send)	US
RevenueCat	Subscription management	US
Railway	Our backend hosting (US-East)	US
Costco Same-Day Delivery	Read-only price scrapes	CA

Cross-border transfer disclosed in Privacy Policy §10.

What we DON'T do

Putting these here so a reviewer doesn't have to ask:

- We don't sell or share data with advertisers or data brokers.
- We don't use cross-context behavioural advertising.
- We don't track users across apps or websites (no IDFA / GAID usage).
- We don't have automated decision-making that affects users (no AI-driven pricing decisions, no algorithmic profiling).
- We don't process payments directly — Apple / Google / RevenueCat handle all subscription billing.

- We don't access contacts, calendar, microphone, precise location, or health data. Location is coarse-only, used solely to pick the nearest Costco.

Subscription tiers + credit packs

Tested via App Store / Play Store sandbox accounts. RevenueCat is wired end-to-end; subscription entitlements flip the in-app premium flag (unlocks PDF export and email sync), and consumable credit-pack purchases land via the RC `NON_RENEWING_PURCHASE` webhook → backend ledger.

- **Free trial** — 75 credits granted once at install (lifetime allowance, not a monthly reset). Anti-reinstall enforced via device fingerprint on the backend. 1 credit = 1 scan; 75 credits cover up to 75 scans **or** ~\$5 of refund claims at the 15 credits / \$ rate (or any mix).
- **One-time credit packs** (no expiry) — Starter \$3 (250 credits) · Pro \$5 (500 credits) · Max \$10 (1,100 credits). Same 1 credit = 1 scan math, and claims cost `floor(savings_in_$ × 15)` credits. Larger packs give more credits per dollar (Max is the best value).
- **Unlimited** — auto-renewing subscription, \$4.99/mo or \$49.99/yr (annual = 12 months for the price of 10, i.e. 2 free months). Both cycles unlock: unlimited scans, no per-drop charge, email sync (Gmail + Outlook), PDF export, advanced analytics, priority price checking (every 2 h). **Family Sharing is deliberately off** on both subscriptions in App Store Connect — the app has no family- or device-sharing behaviour, and the paywall no longer claims any (see Bugs_Common_Fixes #135).

There are no grandfathered/legacy subscription tiers: the old monthly Starter/Pro subs and the `priceback_topup_50` pack were removed in migration 0005 (no pre-launch purchases existed), so the paywall shows only the packs and Unlimited above.

The catalog above is the only place we publish it — the canonical definitions live in `shared/pricing.config.js` and every screen, gate, and legal disclosure reads from there.

Known testing notes

- The first OCR call after install can take 5–10 seconds (cold backend).
- Price refresh can return "no current price" for obscure SKUs that aren't on the Costco Same-Day Delivery catalog. This is expected.
- Push notifications arrive on a once-a-day cron after the receipt is saved. To test push delivery on-demand, the maintainer can hit `POST /api/check-all` on the backend.

Contact for review questions

- Engineering / product: Maxim Lucas — maxim.lucas@viacesi.fr
- Privacy / legal: privacy@priceback.ca
- Security: security@priceback.ca

We respond within 1 business day to reviewer questions.